of a privileged socio-economic class, which also meant that they had a greater inclination towards politics, acquiring this aptitude as part of their grooming within the family. In other instances students from these localities mentioned how they were active as part of a forum or an NGO, while others cited social work as a political activity: '*Yes, I love politics, actually I am aware of the current affairs of a number of countries but I just love Pakistani politics because they are so much you know attractive*' (Student, Male, DG Khan). This attraction, though, seldom translated into actual action.

A minority of students do take part in political campaigns. With regard to university students it was those who take political science courses who were the ones with more political awareness and were generally perceived as the 'politically active' lot. Students who are politically active are also the ones who are part of political or law societies or Amnesty International university chapters.

However, this begs the question of what political activity actually means for those who do profess to 'participate' beyond university clubs and societies. Most of those who classified themselves as politically active said that they are active because they watch political shows on TV and discuss it with their family or friends. They keep track of current affairs through electronic and print media, take part in political discussions or chose it as a subject for a degree programme. For most, being aware (through electronic or print media) of the country's politics is tantamount to being 'politically active'. '*Yes, I'm very much into politics. I watch political shows and am also interested in newspaper. I also discuss politics with my parents and colleagues*' (Student, Male, Lahore).

This would not be classified as active if one goes by the definition offered by Verba et al., as it does not try to affect or influence the behaviour of the government. However, as mentioned in the beginning of this chapter, there are student groups such as the Democratic Student Alliance, the Progressive Students Collective, the Feminist Collective, the Women's Collective, Girls at Dhabas – groups that have been formed by young people often promoting leftists or feminist ideals across educational institutions by using social media to organize and coordinate. While such groups have support and large numbers of members on social media pages, only a small number of young people physically take part in their events. Social media, however, does become a platform to raise awareness (see Chapter 5).

The role of media is also clearly important. Pakistan today has hundreds of channels and many broadcast political debates. However, in this case political awareness (through the media) is confused with political activity, which also highlights the extent of political disengagement where interfacing with political